

Using MB4C: Morning Brief for Claude

This guide is for the person using MB4C day to day. It covers installing the plugin, setting it up, and everything on the Day Sheet.

What you need

- A **paid Claude plan** (Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise). Plugins in Cowork and artifacts that use connectors are paid-plan features.
- The **Claude desktop app** or Claude on the web.
- Your **Gmail** and **Google Calendar** connected in Claude. **Google Drive** is optional; it's only used to save email attachments.
- On a **Team or Enterprise** plan, your admin may need to allow connectors, and "Enable artifact connectors" under Settings → Capabilities.

Install

From a zip file you were given:

1. In Claude, open **Customize → Plugins**.
2. Select **Add → Upload plugin** and choose the `mb4c-plugin-<version>.zip` file.
3. Start a new conversation and type `/mb4c:setup`.

From the GitHub repository:

1. Open **Customize → Plugins** and select **Add → Add marketplace**.
2. Enter `ashgoodman/morningbrief4claude`.
3. If the repository is private, Claude asks you to connect GitHub and give the Claude GitHub App access to it. Your GitHub account must be able to see the repository.
4. Select **Morning Brief for Claude**, then **Add**.
5. Start a new conversation and type `/mb4c:setup`.

Setup (`/mb4c:setup`)

Claude walks you through, one step at a time:

1. **Connect Gmail and Google Calendar** (Customize → Connectors). Sign in with the Google account you use for work.
2. **Publish your Day Sheet**. Claude creates your own private copy of the dashboard and gives you its link. Open it and allow the permissions it asks for (Gmail, Google Calendar, Google Drive, and Claude, which it uses to sort new email by priority with a little of your own usage).
3. **Run the text brief once** to check the priorities look right.
4. **Schedule the text brief** every weekday morning, if you want it.

Pin or bookmark the Day Sheet link so it's one tap away. To make it again or update it later, type `/mb4c:dashboard`.

The Day Sheet

Top of the page

- **The day, with < and >** to step back and forward a day at a time. The label above the date says where you are (Today, Tomorrow, In 3 days...), and **Back to today** appears when you've moved away. Moving between days changes the schedule; your email list is always your inbox as it is now.
- **Settings** (the gear) and **Refresh** (the circular arrow). The page refreshes by itself when you open it if the last refresh is older than you chose in Settings (two hours to begin with). **Refresh** does it now.
- **Email from: Last 24 hours | Whole inbox**, under the two buttons. Last 24 hours brings in new email from the past day; anything already on your list stays until you deal with it. Whole inbox sorts everything in your inbox (up to 150 threads per refresh).
- **Summary chips**, which are also filters. Tap one to see only those items, tap it again (or **All**) to see everything:
 - **for today**: P1 items
 - **waiting on you**: everything in P1, P2 and P3
 - **call-backs**
 - **events**: the schedule of the day you're looking at
 - **work blocks**: only the time you've booked with MB4C that day

The schedule

- Every event that day from every calendar you haven't hidden in Settings, including all-day events and birthdays.
- **Join Meet** appears on video calls (it becomes **Join now** 15 minutes before). **Accept / Maybe / Decline** appear on invitations you haven't answered.
- Under today: **Invitations to answer**, for the next two weeks.
- On a later day: **Coming back** lists the reminders and delegated check-backs due that day.
- MB4C work blocks are marked **Block**. A block that has passed without being done offers **Move to tomorrow** in its ... menu.

Plan my day

Plan my day (or **Plan this day** on a later day) sits beside the schedule. It lays out your open **Work** emails and your **call-backs** in that day's free time:

- Each Work email gets its own block, sized from Claude's estimate, between 30 minutes and 2 hours to start with. Call-backs share one block: 15 minutes plus 5 per call.
- Highest priority goes first, each in the earliest gap it fits.

- **Change any length** (10 minutes to 3 hours) and **change the order** with ↑ and ↓. The times move to fit as you go. An item that no longer fits stays in the list marked **Doesn't fit**, so you can shorten it, move it earlier, or untick it.
- It only uses your working days and hours (set in Settings), keeps 10 minutes clear of other events, and never suggests time that has already passed. On a day you don't work, it asks first: **Plan it anyway**, or plan your next working day instead.
- Untick any you don't want, then **Add to your calendar**. Emails that already have a block from today on are left out.
- Blocks keep their plain title (for example "Draft the Acme quote"). The first line of each block's description says "Added to your calendar by MB4C (Morning Brief for Claude)", followed by the email it's for.

Needs you

Every email still waiting on you, sorted by Claude into:

- **P1 Today**: a deadline today or tomorrow, money at stake, an unhappy customer, a real person blocked on you, a genuine security alert.
- **P2 This week**: a real person waiting, no stated urgency.
- **P3 When there's time**: FYI mail, receipts, notices.

Each group folds (Show / Hide), and remembers how you left it. The filter chips **All · Unread · Call-backs · Work** narrow the list further.

The list follows your Gmail inbox. Emails you reply to, archive or delete in Gmail itself leave the Day Sheet at the next refresh, and move to **Handled**. **Waiting on others** is different: it comes from mail you sent, so an empty inbox doesn't clear it.

Start of the week

On the first day of your week (Monday unless you change it in Settings), a **Start of the week** box sits at the top of Needs you. It lists:

- emails that have been waiting on you (P2 and P3) for more than a week;
- emails you sent that have had no reply for more than a week;
- delegated emails with no check-back date;
- reminders coming back this week.

Deal with them from there as usual. **Done for this week** hides the box until your next week starts. If you skip the first day, it's still there the next day. You can turn it off, or bring it back, in Settings.

The square at the left of each card: **filled @** = unread, **outlined @** = read but not actioned, **→** = an email you sent (Waiting on others).

What's on a card

Buttons you can tap straight from the card:

Button	What it does
Draft a quick reply → / Draft a reply →	Opens the item with Claude already writing a reply. Edit it, then Save to Gmail Drafts . It isn't sent until you send it from Drafts or Gmail.
Book time →	Opens the item with the booking fields ready: your next working day, and the first free gap in your working hours from that day's calendar. Change the day and it finds a gap on that day. Add to calendar books the block, with a note in its description that MB4C added it.
Call +63...	Starts a phone call on a phone.
WhatsApp	Opens a WhatsApp chat with that number. Shown only when the email says the number is on WhatsApp.
Copy	Copies the number.
Spam / Delete	On noise and likely-spam cards only: moves the email to Spam or Trash. Both can be undone.

Labels (information only): **Call back, Work, ~60 min** (Claude's estimate), **Scheduled Sat 2:00 PM, FYI, Follow up, Reminder, N attachments**, and notes such as **New message since you handled this** or **Did Sam handle this?**

The ... menu on an email

Tap ... for everything else. The top shows who it's from, the subject, a one-line summary and why it got its priority. Below that:

- **Open in Gmail** (and **Get the Gmail app** on iPhone).
- **Show the email**: loads the text of the last few messages.
- **Attachments**, each with **Save to Drive** and then **Open in Drive**.
- Call buttons, for call-backs.

The actions:

Action	What it does
Done	Clears it from your list.
Replied	You've answered it. (MB4C also notices replies you send from Gmail and clears those itself.)
Draft reply	Claude drafts a reply into Gmail Drafts.
Remind me	Hides it until tomorrow, in 3 days, in a week, or in any number of days. Optionally puts a 15-minute reminder on your calendar that day (at the time set in Settings) so your phone alerts you.
Reschedule	Moves it to another day.
Book time	Books a work block for it (work items only).
Priority	Moves it to P1, P2, P3, Noise or Spam. Your choice sticks.

Action	What it does
Delegated	Who has it, and when to check back. It comes back that day asking "Did they handle this?" You can also label it in Gmail.
Log call	"Spoke to them" (done), or "Left a message / no answer" (back in 2 days). Call-backs only.
Archive	Takes it out of your Gmail inbox.
Label	Files it under a Gmail label (or a new one), and optionally archives it.
Sender rule	From now on, mail from this sender is always P1, P2 or P3, always noise (optionally filed to a label and archived), or always spam. Rules apply on every refresh and are listed in Settings , where you can remove them.
Spam	Reports it as spam in Gmail.
Delete	Moves it to Gmail's Trash.

There's no "remove" for email: each one has to end up somewhere.

When you tap an action that needs more (Remind me, Label, Delegated...), its options open under the email and above the action buttons.

Calendar events' ... menu

- **Done** ticks it off: it stays on the schedule with a check mark. **Not done** takes the check mark off.
- **Reschedule** moves the event in Google Calendar and keeps its length; it warns you if guests will be notified or you're not the organiser.
- **Delegated**, and **Remove** (hides it from the schedule).
- **Open in Google Calendar** and **Join Google Meet**.

New event

+ **Event** beside the schedule adds an event of your own, such as a doctor's appointment. Fill in:

- what it is, and the day (it starts on the day you're looking at);
- a start time and length, or **All day**;
- where, and notes, if you like;
- which calendar, if you have more than one you can add to;
- a reminder: your calendar's usual reminders, none, or 10 minutes, 30 minutes, 1 hour or 1 day before.

It's added as an ordinary event, not an MB4C block, and no one is invited.

New email

+ **Email** beside Needs you starts a new email. Fill in To (and Cc or Bcc if you need them), a subject and the message. To have Claude write it, type what it should say, such as "ask Dr

Reyes to move Wednesday's appointment to Friday", and select **Write it for me**. Edit the result, then **Save to Gmail Drafts**. It isn't sent until you send it.

Drafts

The envelope at the top opens **Drafts**: your Gmail drafts, newest first, including replies drafted from the Day Sheet. Each has:

- **Send...**, which shows the From address and the recipients and asks you to confirm before it sends. A sent email can't be unsent from here.
- **Open in Gmail**, to edit it. Edit drafts in Gmail, where their attachments are kept.
- **Delete...**, which asks first.

A draft with no recipient can't be sent until you add one in Gmail.

Which address it's sent from: the Gmail tools Claude uses have no way to choose a From address. A draft goes from the address saved on it. Drafts the Day Sheet creates get the address Gmail chooses. If you have several "Send mail as" addresses, open the draft in Gmail, pick the From address there, and then send it from Drafts or Gmail.

For replies, the Day Sheet checks for you. After it saves a reply draft, it reads back the From address Gmail chose and compares it with the address the email was sent to. If they're different, it says so, such as "It will be sent from you@main.com, but the email was sent to sales@yourshop.com", so you can change From in Gmail before sending.

Swipes (touch screens)

- **Swipe right:** Done.
- **Swipe left:** see it again tomorrow.

Both show **Undo**. Swipes work with a finger or pen, not a mouse drag.

Keyboard shortcuts (computers)

Press **?** on the page to see them. **j** and **k** move between emails in Needs you, and the selected one is outlined.

Key	Does
j / k	Next / previous email
o or Enter	Open its actions
e	Done
r	Draft a reply
b	Book time (Work emails)
h	Hide it until tomorrow
#	Delete (moves it to Gmail's Trash, with Undo)
← / →	Previous / next day

Key	Does
t	Back to today
p	Plan the day you're looking at
n	New event
c	New email
d	Drafts
,	Settings
Esc	Close

Shortcuts don't fire while you're typing in a box. Turn them off in Settings.

Settings

Everything you can change lives here. It's saved as you change it, and the same on every device you open the Day Sheet on.

- **Email**
- **Archive in Gmail when handled.** Marking an email Done, Replied or Delegated also archives it in Gmail.
- **Keep handled emails listed for** 7, 14 or 30 days.
- **Refresh by itself when opened**, if the last refresh is older than 1, 2, 4 or 8 hours, or never.
- **Working days and hours**
- **Working days:** tick the days you work (Monday to Friday to begin with).
- **Working day starts / ends** (9:00 to 18:00 to begin with). Book time and Plan my day only suggest times in between, on your working days.
- **Calendar**
- **Calendar reminders go at.** The time of day for Remind me's calendar reminder.
- **Calendars to show.** Untick any you don't want on the Day Sheet.
- **Week**
- **My week starts on** any day of the week.
- **Show the start-of-week reset**, and **Show this week's reset again** after you've marked it done.
- **Appearance**
- **Light or dark: Match system | Light | Dark.**
- **Colour theme:** MB4C's own colours, or one of five open-source code editor themes: Solarized, Nord, Gruvbox, Catppuccin or Dracula, each in its light and dark version. They use each theme's published colours (all five are MIT licensed); a few colours are darkened or lightened so text keeps a contrast of at least 4.5:1.
- **Display**
- **Text size: Small | Medium | Large.** Changes the size of all the text on the page.
- **Keyboard shortcuts** on or off, and **See the shortcuts.**

- **Sender rules.** Every rule you've made, each with **Remove**.

Further down the page

- **Waiting on others:** mail you sent 2 to 21 days ago that asks for something and hasn't had an answer, each with a one-line summary of what you asked for. ... → **Nudge them** drafts a follow-up; **Show what you sent** shows your message.
- Emails sent only to yourself are left out.
- Claude reads each one and leaves out emails that don't need an answer, such as sharing a link or a file, saying thanks, or confirming something. They go to **Handled** as "Not waiting on a reply". If Claude got one wrong, select **Undo** and it comes back.
- **Reminders later:** items you've hidden, with the day they come back.
- **Delegated:** with their check-back dates.
- **Noise and likely spam:** with one-tap Spam and Delete.
- **Handled:** everything you've dealt with recently (two weeks unless you change it in Settings), each with **Undo** (which also takes an email back out of Trash or Spam).

Opening Google's apps on a phone

- **Calendar** links open the Google Calendar app on iPhone when it's installed (Google's own link settings assign event links to it).
- **Gmail** links open Gmail on the web on iPhone: Google doesn't provide a documented link into a specific email in the Gmail app. A **Get the Gmail app** link sits beside it.
- **Meet** and **Drive** links can open those apps.
- On **Android**, the links name the app and fall back to its Play Store page. Whether they open the app from inside the Claude app depends on the Claude app, so a plain web link is always there too.

Privacy

- Your Day Sheet is private to you. It uses your own connectors; nobody else can see your email or calendar through it.
- What you do on it (done, reminders, sender rules, settings) is saved in the Day Sheet's own private storage and follows you across devices.
- Email text is sent to Claude only to sort it, summarise it and draft replies, using your own Claude account.
- An email is sent only when you choose **Send** on the Drafts screen and confirm, or send it from Gmail yourself. Nothing is archived, deleted, filed or booked without your tap, except what your own sender rules say to do.

If something isn't working

You see	Try
"Gmail isn't connected" / "Google Calendar isn't connected"	Connect it in Customize → Connectors (or Settings → Connectors), then reload the page.

You see	Try
"needs reconnecting"	Reconnect that connector in Settings → Connectors.
"This page isn't allowed to use ..."	You declined a permission. Reload the page and allow it.
"blocked" by your organisation	Ask your admin to allow that connector action, and artifact connectors.
Sorted "by simple rules"	Claude wasn't available or your usage limit was reached; Refresh later.
Save to Drive says the file is too large	Open the email in Gmail and use Gmail's Add to Drive .
No Save to Drive button	Google Drive isn't connected; it's optional.